

WHERE I AM NOT SUPPOSED TO BE

A story by Dequinte

A story of one final year, the people who changed it,
and the choices that followed.

WHERE I AM NOT SUPPOSED TO BE

© 2026 Dequinte. All rights reserved.

This manuscript is based on the life story and memories provided by the author. Literary descriptions, transitions, atmosphere, and dialogue have been developed to turn those memories into a book-length reading experience, while the major events and relationships remain grounded in the author's account.

Contents

1. Chapter One — The Staff Room
2. Chapter Two — The Road to Greenspring
3. Chapter Three — The Rich Kid Arrives
4. Chapter Four — Irene and Olivier
5. Chapter Five — Nanette
6. Chapter Six — Delice's Smile
7. Chapter Seven — Fis
8. Chapter Eight — The Kiss
9. Chapter Nine — Samuela
10. Chapter Ten — Nanette Watches
11. Chapter Eleven — Angle
12. Chapter Twelve — The Wrong Place
13. Chapter Thirteen — The Fake Party
14. Chapter Fourteen — The Day After
15. Chapter Fifteen — What We Were Afraid to Say
16. Chapter Sixteen — Two People, One Quiet Life
17. Chapter Seventeen — The Last Days of S6
18. Chapter Eighteen — Graduation
19. Chapter Nineteen — The Story on the Computer
20. Chapter Twenty — The Wrong Table

Chapter One — The Staff Room

The staff room was quieter than usual. Deking Johnson sat on a chair with his hands resting between his knees. The room was not unfamiliar to him, but that morning it felt completely different. The walls, the desks, the papers, the teachers moving quietly around him—everything looked ordinary. Yet Deking knew that something in his life was about to stop being ordinary. Across from him sat the headmaster. Beside Deking were his parents. His parents were not surprised to be there. They already knew that Deking's behavior had been becoming a problem. There was no need for them to exchange shocked looks or ask what had happened. They had talked with him about his choices before. They knew their son. The headmaster looked at Deking for a moment before speaking. "Deking," he said, calmly but firmly, "your discipline is not fit for this school." Deking kept quiet. "You are not supposed to be here in this school anymore. You need to search for another school." The sentence was simple. It did not need shouting. Deking heard it clearly. He wanted to answer. He wanted to explain himself, perhaps even defend himself. But the words did not come out the way he wanted. His speech became hesitant and broken. He stumbled over the beginning of what he wanted to say, then stopped. Silence returned. The headmaster turned toward Deking's parents. "If he doesn't change his behavior," he told them, "he will face many

consequences in life.” Deking looked down. He had heard warnings before. But this one felt different because it was no longer a warning about what might happen. It was happening. His parents listened. They knew this was not a sudden decision made because of one isolated moment. Deking’s behavior had brought him there. Finally, Deking stood. There was no argument. No dramatic speech. No promise that he would somehow change everything before leaving. He simply walked out. As he moved through the school, he saw some students crying. Others stopped him to say goodbye. Some thanked him for the memories they had shared with him. Deking had never imagined leaving like this. He had expected another year. Instead, he was leaving. He nodded to the people who spoke to him and continued walking. When he reached home, he went into the living room and packed his clothes. His parents did not need to explain what was happening. They had already made the decision with him: he would leave the old school and go somewhere else where he could continue his education in S6. A driver was waiting outside. Deking put his bags into the car and climbed into the back seat. As the car moved away, he looked through the window. The school became smaller. Then smaller again. Finally, it disappeared. Deking did not know that he would never return there. He did not know that he would never see those people again. And he certainly did not know that the next school would become the setting for one of the most

complicated years of his life. He only knew one thing. He had been sent away because of the way he had been living. Now he had one year left to finish secondary school. One year. One new school. And a version of himself he had not yet met.

Chapter Two — The Road to Greenspring

The journey took about an hour. For most of the drive, Deking watched the road through the window. He was still thinking about the staff room. The headmaster's voice kept returning to him. Your discipline is not fit for this school. He did not know whether he was angry, embarrassed, relieved, or simply tired. Perhaps he was all of them at once. He had come from a rich family. He was used to being comfortable. He was used to looking good, having money, and knowing that there were always possibilities around him. Now he was going somewhere new. Greenspring A Secondary School. He knew very little about it compared with the school he had just left. What he did know was enough to make him understand that the two environments were different. Deking's family could afford things that many students could not. At the old school, wealth had never seemed strange to him because he was surrounded by it. Greenspring would make him notice it. When the car finally arrived, Deking stepped out in his school uniform. He looked at the school. This was it. There was no turning back. He adjusted himself, took his things, and entered. For a short moment he wondered what people would think of him. Would they know where he came from? Would they treat him differently? Would he be able to fit in? He had

no answers. He only had confidence. That confidence would help him. Sometimes it would also get him into trouble.

Chapter Three — The Rich Kid Arrives

Before Deking could settle into his new school, a member of staff took him to the staff room. The welcome was not the welcome he had imagined. The staff member knew that Deking came from a wealthy background. Instead of treating that fact as something ordinary, he decided to use it to humble him. “Since you come from a rich school,” the staff member said, “let’s see how you behave here.” Deking was told to kneel. Then came the humiliating instruction: cut his nails using his teeth. Deking stared for a moment. There were no students watching. Only staff members were there. The humiliation was private. Deking could have made a scene. He could have refused. But he simply did it. He did not care enough to fight over it. When it was finished, he stood up and walked out. That was the first lesson Greenspring gave him. Here, nobody was impressed simply because he had money. He entered his class and found Irene and Olivier. Olivier was the only person there he already knew from primary school. Irene was a friend he made at the new school. Their presence made the place feel less foreign. Deking sat with them. He began observing. The students were generally clean and nice. They were not the caricature of poor students he had imagined. They were simply students living in a different environment. Deking slowly became comfortable. Teachers liked him, especially because he knew French. Students

noticed him too. His confidence made him visible. His money made him even more visible. Soon people knew him as the rich kid. Some treated him normally. Some treated him differently. Deking didn't mind. In fact, part of him enjoyed the attention. He had entered Greenspring believing he was being punished. But after only a short time, he discovered that being the new rich kid came with its own kind of popularity. He did not yet understand that popularity could open doors and close others at the same time.

Chapter Four — Irene and Olivier

The first days at a new school are usually full of small uncertainties. Where do you sit? Who do you talk to? Who can you trust? Deking was lucky. Irene and Olivier gave him a place to belong. Olivier's connection to Deking went further back. They had known each other from primary school, so there was no need to explain everything from the beginning. Irene was different. She was part of the new world Deking was entering. The three became a comfortable group. Deking could joke with them. He could sit beside them. He could talk without worrying about how much of his past they knew. That mattered. He had left a school where everybody knew him. At Greenspring, he had to build himself again. With Irene and Olivier around, he did not feel completely alone. The year began to move. Classes. Breaks. Conversations. The ordinary rhythm of school. Deking was still Deking. He liked looking good. He liked attention. He liked girls. He liked spending money. But Greenspring was slowly becoming more than a temporary place. It was becoming his world. And then, about a week after his arrival, another name entered that world. Nanette.

Chapter Five — Nanette

Deking heard about Nanette from friends. They gave him her contact and told him she was the kind of girl who fit him. She was popular. She was attractive. People knew her. Deking was interested almost immediately. Popularity mattered to him then. He liked being connected to people who were noticed. When he met Nanette, the conversation came naturally. They became friends. Then the friendship became something closer. Soon they were walking together at school, sitting together, and visiting each other's places. There was excitement in the relationship. Deking enjoyed being seen with her. Nanette was part of his social world, and through her, Deking's own popularity seemed to grow. For a while, everything worked. But time has a way of exposing things that excitement can hide. They did not always have enough time for each other. The relationship slowly became harder to maintain. Eventually they broke up. There was no dramatic war. They simply went separate ways. Two roads. Two directions. Deking continued with his life. Nanette continued with hers. But later, when Nanette would see Deking chasing another girl, the breakup would feel very different to her. She would watch him. And she would be hurt. Deking would not fully understand what she was feeling until much later. At that moment, he was already looking toward another part of the school. Another girl. Another smile. Another story.

Chapter Six — Delice's Smile

About one month after Deking arrived at Greenspring, he saw Delice. She was near her classroom with a group of mostly girls. They were laughing. Delice was telling them a story. Then she smiled. Deking noticed the smile before he noticed anything else. Something about her stopped his attention. He wanted to keep looking. Then he wanted to know her. His first plan was simple: become her friend. So he joined the group. Delice was good to him. She was friendly. She was easy to talk to. The more Deking spent time around her, the more his feelings grew. He began looking for her without planning to. A normal school day could become better simply because he saw her. And the opposite was also true. If Delice was sad, Deking felt it. That became his greatest weakness. Her happiness became his strength. But there was something about Delice's heart that Deking had not yet understood. She already had feelings for someone else. His name was Fis. Deking learned about him through Yvette, Delice's best friend. Fis was also new to the school and was in S6, though not in Deking's class. He was popular. He was lovable. Deking became his friend. That friendship created one of the strangest situations of Deking's school year. Fis did not know that Deking loved Delice. Delice did not know that Deking knew about Fis. And Deking was caught between friendship and love, watching a girl choose someone who did not know

he was being chosen.

Chapter Seven — Fis

Deking never hated Fis. That was what made everything harder. Fis was his friend. People liked him. He was popular and easy to love. Deking could not simply decide that Fis was a bad person because Delice loved him. So Deking did what he could. He stayed close to Delice. He remained friends with Fis. And he kept the truth inside himself. Yvette knew more than most people. She was Delice's best friend, so she knew where Delice's heart was. She also became one of the people Deking talked to when he was having a bad day. She supported him. She told him things about Delice. She was there when he felt low. Deking did not realize how important that support was. He was too focused on the person he wanted. He wanted Delice to see him differently. He wanted a chance. He wanted the story in his head to become real. Eventually he tried to kiss her. She refused. The moment hurt. But Deking stepped back. He stayed her friend. That decision mattered. Love could make him reckless, but it did not give him the right to force Delice to feel something she did not feel. He waited. And later, when he least expected it, Delice kissed him.

Chapter Eight — The Kiss

They were walking home. Deking was making jokes. Delice was laughing. For a while, everything felt light. When they reached their destination, they stopped. They hugged. Then Delice kissed him. For Deking, the moment became enormous. A single kiss could carry a thousand meanings when you desperately wanted it to mean something. He wondered whether everything had changed. Maybe Delice finally saw him. Maybe she had chosen him. Maybe he had a chance. He did not rush to decide. He watched what happened afterward. And slowly, the truth became clear. The kiss had not changed Delice's feelings. It had only been a kiss. Deking was left with the same problem. He loved someone whose heart was elsewhere. That was the kind of pain nobody could see. You could smile. You could attend class. You could joke with your friends. You could walk beside the person you loved. And still carry disappointment inside you. Deking kept going. He had no choice. School did not stop because his heart was confused. There were lessons. Friends. Girls. Money. Stories. And another friend who would soon betray his trust.

Chapter Nine — Samuela

Samuela and Deking became friends in class. There were moments when the teacher was out and students were free to talk. Deking noticed her. He thought she looked good and decided he should not resist becoming her friend. With Samuela, Deking wanted to look experienced. He wanted to impress her. He wanted to look like the ladies' man people already believed he was. So he told stories. Some were true. Some were not. He told her stories about dates with Nanette. The problem was that some of those dates had never happened. At the time, Deking thought the lies were harmless. They made him look more experienced. They made his stories sound better. He did not imagine that the person listening would one day repeat them. After his relationship with Nanette ended, Deking remained single while his friendship with Delice continued. He still talked to Samuela. He told her about his past relationships and the things he had done. But he made one thing clear: he had never done those things with Nanette. Samuela remembered. Then she took the information to Nanette. She told Nanette everything. The stories. The lies. The things Deking had claimed. Nanette was hurt. The old relationship suddenly had a new wound. Samuela had taken something Deking had trusted her with and carried it somewhere else. Nanette became angry. And revenge began taking shape. Mamy became involved. Samuela agreed to

help. Deking knew nothing. He continued walking through school as if everything were normal. Sometimes the most dangerous part of a secret is not knowing that one exists.

Chapter Ten — Nanette Watches

After the breakup, Nanette and Deking had gone separate ways. But going separate ways did not mean becoming strangers. Nanette could still see him. And eventually she saw something that hurt. Deking was chasing Delice. She saw the attention. She saw the effort. She saw the way his eyes followed Delice. For Nanette, the sight carried memories of what they had once been. She had been close to him. Now she was watching him give that attention to someone else. The sadness was quiet. Deking did not always notice it. He was too busy chasing a person who might never become his. This was one of the strange things about the year. Deking was hurting because Delice loved Fis. Nanette was hurting because Deking was chasing Delice. And Samuela was helping turn the old hurt into anger. The relationships around Deking were becoming connected in ways he could not see. He thought he was living separate stories. They were actually becoming one story. His story.

Chapter Eleven — Angle

By the middle of third term, Deking's life had another secret. It began during group work. The teacher placed Deking and Angle in the same group. At first, it was simply schoolwork. But attraction developed between them. What happened next became a secret relationship. Four weeks. Four weeks in the middle of third term. Deking kept it hidden. Delice never suspected. Yvette never suspected. Nobody knew. Deking was already in love with Delice, yet he was secretly involved with another girl. It was one of the contradictions inside him. He wanted Delice. He wanted attention. He wanted excitement. And he had not yet learned how to separate wanting something from being ready to live with its consequences. The relationship with Angle eventually ended when she moved to another city. The secret went with her. But Deking did not become free of it simply because Angle was gone. Some memories leave a person with questions. What was I doing? Why did I do it? What would have happened if someone had known? Deking did not answer those questions. He simply kept moving. There was still school to finish. There were still people around him. And there was still a revenge plan he knew nothing about.

Chapter Twelve — The Wrong Place

Deking had always known he was different at Greenspring. Money made that difference visible. He could spend money on girls. He could spend money on grooming and looking good. He could spend money on things other students might need to save for. Sometimes he looked around and saw students struggling to pay their school fees. Then he thought about how easily he could spend an amount equal to school fees on one dinner. The contrast was uncomfortable. At his old school, wealth had been normal. At Greenspring, wealth made him stand out. Some people treated him like a normal student. Others saw the rich kid first. Deking sometimes felt that he was sitting at the wrong table. He had been removed from one school because of his behavior and placed in another. He had lost the environment he was used to. But maybe the deeper lesson was not about school. It was about choices. A person can have money and still make poor decisions. A person can have popularity and still feel lonely. A person can have many people around them and still be chasing the one person who will not choose them. Deking had all of those things. And he was still learning how to understand himself.

Chapter Thirteen — The Fake Party

Near the end of third term, Deking was still living as if nothing could catch up with him. Then Mamy invited him to a party. At least, that was what he believed. He arrived expecting a normal gathering. Instead, he was led into a dark room. The door closed. Deking waited. Something felt wrong. Then he heard voices. Samuela. Nanette. Mamy. The truth began to appear. There was no ordinary party. It had been arranged for him. They wanted him to pay for what he had done. They told him things he did not want to hear. They took his expensive watch. The boy who had always used confidence to protect himself suddenly had nothing to hide behind. He could not buy his way out of the room. He could not impress them. He could not turn the moment into a joke. He had to listen. For once, Deking was the one receiving the consequences. The experience stayed with him. When he finally went home, he did not tell his parents. He did not tell Irene. He did not tell Olivier. He did not tell Yvette. Instead, he opened his computer. He started writing. He wrote about the room. The people. The feelings. The humiliation. The memories. He wrote because he was afraid that one day he would forget how the moment had felt. And while writing, he discovered something unexpected. He liked it. The story did not disappear when he put it into words. It became something he could keep. That night was the first time Deking truly thought

about writing a book.

Chapter Fourteen — The Day After

The next morning, Deking went to school as usual. Nothing outside him looked different. Inside, everything felt different. He spent the whole day thinking about Yvette. Why her? The question kept returning. Perhaps because she had been there. When he was having a bad day, she was there. When Delice hurt him, she listened. When he was confused, she stayed close. Deking had spent so much time looking at the person he wanted that he had not fully noticed the person who was already choosing him. The fake party had changed something. He no longer wanted to keep running from one girl to another. He wanted to focus on one person. He wanted to try. For the first time, the idea of choosing someone because she chose him felt more important than the excitement of being wanted by many. Two days after the party, he got his chance to speak to Yvette.

Chapter Fifteen — What We Were Afraid to Say

Deking and Yvette were doing homework at home. The work was there in front of them, but neither of them was completely focused. Delice was also there. Eventually she decided to leave. The room became quieter. Deking looked at Yvette. Yvette looked back. There was something between them that had been growing for a long time. Deking wanted to say it. But fear stopped him. "I want to tell you something," he said, "but I don't know how to start." Yvette waited. "I don't want to lose you too." He had already experienced the pain of wanting Delice and not being chosen. He was afraid that saying what he felt to Yvette might destroy the friendship they had. Yvette took a breath. "I want to tell you something too," she said. "But I don't know how my friend will take it." Deking knew who she meant. Delice. Delice knew their bond was supposed to be friendship. Nothing more. For a moment neither of them spoke. Then Deking finally said the words. "I love you." Yvette looked at him. "I love you too." The words changed the room. Deking had chosen Yvette. He knew she loved him. He wanted to try to love her. He did not know what the future would make of those feelings. He did not know whether love could be chosen and then grow into something deeper. He only knew what he felt in that moment. And for once, he

wanted to stop chasing someone who was looking in another direction. He wanted to stay with someone who was looking at him.

Chapter Sixteen — Two People, One Quiet Life

The relationship between Deking and Yvette was not built from dramatic arguments. It was built from small moments. They walked together at night. They visited the lake when it was just the two of them. They studied for the national exams. They went home at night holding hands. Sometimes Yvette would ride on the back of Deking. They bought ice cream. They bought street food. They laughed. Those ordinary moments became some of Deking's favorite memories. There was something peaceful about them. He had spent so much of the year surrounded by attention, secrets and complicated feelings. With Yvette, he could simply be present. He did not tell her everything. She knew about Nanette. She did not know about Angle. She did not know everything about the fake party. Nanette, Samuela and Mamy did not know that Deking and Yvette had become a couple. Their relationship existed quietly. Deking also continued to carry Delice somewhere inside him. That truth did not disappear just because he was with Yvette. But he did not want to destroy what he had. So he tried. He tried to be present. He tried to choose one person. He tried to become someone different from the boy who had arrived at Greenspring. Whether trying would be enough was a question he did not yet have to answer.

Chapter Seventeen — The Last Days of S6

The end of secondary school approached. Everything suddenly seemed temporary. The classrooms. The uniforms. The conversations during breaks. The walks home. The jokes with friends. Even the things Deking had once complained about began to feel like memories before they were gone. Irene and Olivier were preparing for what came next. They had received educational scholarships to study abroad. Deking was finishing his own journey. He thought about the boy who had arrived at Greenspring months earlier. That boy had believed he was being punished. He had thought the school was beneath him. He had thought the year would simply be something to survive. But the year had given him friendships. It had given him heartbreak. It had shown him betrayal. It had shown him the consequences of lying. It had introduced him to a girl he could not have. It had introduced him to another girl who loved him. It had taught him that popularity could disappear. It had taught him that money could not solve every problem. And it had given him a reason to write. The school was ending. But the story was not finished. Not completely.

Chapter Eighteen — Graduation

Graduation day arrived. Deking stood among the people who had become part of his final year. Irene was there. Olivier was there. Delice was there. Yvette was there. The school felt different that day. Everyone was dressed for an ending. There was happiness in the room, but there was also the quiet knowledge that everyone would leave and become part of different lives. Deking looked at the people around him. So much had happened in one year. He thought about the staff room where his previous school had ended for him. He thought about the drive to Greenspring. The first humiliating day. Irene and Olivier. Nanette. Delice's smile. Fis. Yvette. Samuela. Angle. The fake party. The computer screen. The lake. The night walks. The ice cream. The exams. All of it belonged to one year. One strange, complicated year. Deking graduated. Yvette graduated. Delice graduated. Irene and Olivier moved toward their scholarship opportunities. Angle was already in another city. Nanette and the others were part of the memories Deking would carry with him. Deking and Yvette were still together. They still loved each other. But graduation did not tell them what would happen next. Maybe that was why the day felt so strange. An ending could also be a beginning. And sometimes you could not know which one you were standing inside.

Chapter Nineteen — The Story on the Computer

After school, Deking returned to his computer. He opened the story he had begun after the fake party. At first he had written only because he did not want to forget. Now he understood that he wanted to preserve the entire year. He began again from the beginning. The staff room. The headmaster. His parents. The car. Greenspring. He wrote the names of the people who had changed his year. Nanette. Samuela. Mamy. Angle. Delice. Fis. Yvette. Irene. Olivier. He wrote about friendship and popularity. He wrote about money. He wrote about the strange feeling of entering a place where people saw him differently. He wrote about loving someone who loved somebody else. He wrote about being loved by someone he had not expected to choose. He wrote about mistakes. He wrote about consequences. He wrote because memories can disappear. A conversation can be forgotten. A face can change. A school can be demolished. People can move to different cities. But a story can keep a moment alive. Deking looked at the pages on his screen. He was no longer simply remembering. He was writing. And perhaps that was one of the most important things the year had given him.

Chapter Twenty — The Wrong Table

Deking leaned back from the computer. For a moment, he did not type. He thought about the person he had been when he arrived at Greenspring. A ladies' guy. A rich guy. A lover boy. He had believed that money could make life easier. He had believed popularity could protect him. He had believed that if he wanted someone badly enough, perhaps the story would eventually go his way. The year had taught him otherwise. He had learned that people have their own hearts. That friendships can turn into betrayal. That lies can return to the person who told them. That popularity can be temporary. That money can make you comfortable without making you wise. That love can be real even when it is not returned. And that being chosen by someone does not automatically make your feelings simple. He thought about Delice. He thought about Yvette. He did not know what the future would bring. He did not know where life would take him. He did not know whether every feeling he carried would remain the same. And he did not need to know. Some stories become weaker when they pretend to know the future. This was not a story about predicting what would happen. It was a story about what had happened. Deking looked at the final line. He typed slowly. "What is yours is on the table. Make sure you are not sitting at the wrong table." He read it again. Then he smiled. The story was saved. The year was preserved. And somewhere

between the school he had been forced to leave and the school he had believed he was never supposed to attend, Deking had found something he had not been looking for. His own story. He closed the computer. Outside, life continued. Inside, the pages remained. Not as proof that everything had worked out perfectly. Not as a promise about what would happen next. Just as a record of one year when a boy entered the wrong place, met the right people, made the wrong choices, found unexpected love, lost pieces of himself, and began to understand who he might become. The story ended there. The future did not. **THE END**